

Area of Study 6: Innovations in Music 1900 to the present day

Outline	Learners should study the continuation, development and innovations in music of the Western tradition from 1900 to the present day: • study examples in depth of music from the period of study, using live performances, recordings and scores as appropriate • use attentive listening and contextual knowledge to analyse, evaluate and make critical judgements about the repertoire • use technical vocabulary to communicate a sophisticated understanding of twentieth century and contemporary music and its context.
Focus for learning	Learners should analyse, explain and compare developments in Twentieth and Twenty-first Century styles, including: • late Romantic style, e.g. large scale symphonic works • impressionism • expressionism, atonality and serialism • neo-classical developments, e.g. reinterpretation of traditional forms • national styles, e.g. based on folk traditions • post-1945 avant-garde, experimental approaches, electronic music, post-modern response e.g. to Eastern or African influence • minimalism • contemporary approaches to composition. Learners should study and understand innovations in the use of musical elements, including: • irregular rhythm, metre, polyrhythm, polymetre, organisation of time • pitch, dissonance, harmony, tonality, modality, atonality • exploration of sonority, timbre, textures, instrumental and vocal techniques and resources, percussion, technology • dynamics, contrast, extreme range • structure, form, notation, improvisation, aleatoric. Learners should study and understand the conditions and context in which music of this period was created and performed, including: • audience reaction to innovation • technology and mass media • the response of composers to political and social events, e.g. revolution, war, persecution, censorship • ideas about the function and relevance of music, e.g. Gebrauchsmusik, crossover with popular styles, music for films, propaganda • working conditions for musicians • challenges and issues for performers and composers working today.
Prescribed works	No prescribed works for this Area of Study.